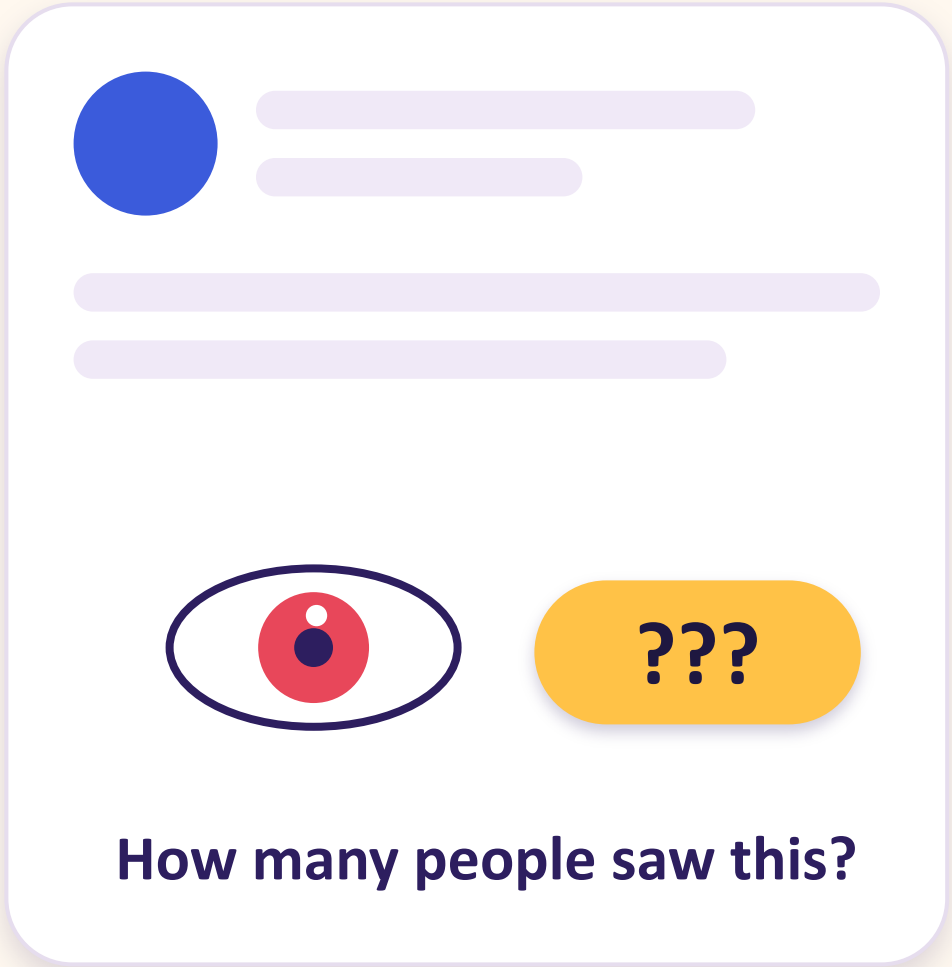
How many people really saw this post?

How to estimate the visibility of social media posts



AMC project · for Brand24

Platforms hide post visibility



1. Reach is often hidden
2. Reach is their product: they sell ads
3. So Brand24 has to estimate

Our hypothesis

HYPOTHESIS

We will estimate post visibility better than the Brand24 rule by combining followers with reactions: likes, comments, shares

TODAY

A single number



followers × constant

OUR IDEA

Estimate + interval



We also know when not to trust it

Refuted if the model does not beat the Brand24 rule on posts with known views

How we will tackle it: the concept

1 Exploration

Gaps, distributions, odd cases

2 Estimation

Model from followers and engagement

3 Validation

Tested where views are known

4 Uncertainty

Intervals and robustness of results

WHAT WE WORK WITH

12,500

mentions, 2,500 from each of 5 platforms

MENTIONS WITH KNOWN VIEWS

TikTok	YouTube	X (Twitter)	Facebook	Instagram
100%	99%	75%	0%	0%

Who benefits?



Companies and brands

They know how many people really saw a mention



Small businesses and NGOs

A reliable picture without costly platform data



Journalists

They see how far disinformation has spread



Media researchers

A measure with uncertainty instead of guessing



All of us

Fewer inflated statistics in circulation

Impact: who gains from this?

5.24 bn

social media accounts:
their posts could be measured more honestly

DataReportal / Kepios, 2025

2,400+

companies use Brand24

figure reported by Brand24

~12,000

people read their reports

assumption: about 5 people per company

A playful estimate: orders of magnitude, not a measurement

Why will we succeed?

FEASIBILITY

- Legal data from the client: Brand24
- 12,500 public mentions, 5 platforms
- Ground truth: TikTok and YouTube
- No personal data of authors (GDPR)
- Preliminary exploration test: promising

EXPERTISE: STATE OF KNOWLEDGE

Cha et al., 2010

Followers are not real influence

Szabo and Huberman, 2010

Content popularity can be predicted

Bakshy et al., 2011

A single post is hard to predict

Angelopoulos and Bates, 2023

Uncertainty intervals with a guarantee